Yanyang Shen

Personal Website: https://yanyangshen.github.io/
Email: yanyangshen3@gmail.com

EDUCATION

East China Normal University, Faculty of Education, Department of Educational Administration
Shanghai, China | Sep 2024 – Jun 2027 (expected) | Advisor: Prof. Yaozong Hu
Master's Degree in Educational Economy and Management | GPA: 3.82/4.00 | Academic Rank: 4/29
Selected Coursework: Educational Statistics; Regression Analysis; Experimental Design; Economics of Education; International Education Policy Analysis; Social Science Foundations of Educational Leadership and Policy
Master's Thesis (in progress): University Program Restructuring and Emerging Industry Development in China

University of Tsukuba, Graduate School of Comprehensive Human Sciences, Division of Education
Tsukuba, Japan | Aug 2025 – Feb 2026 | Advisor: Prof. Yoshinori Shimizu
Exchange Student in Educational Sciences
Selected Coursework: Social Issues and Education Policies; The State of Global Issues

Hohai University, School of Economics and Finance, Department of International Trade
Changzhou, China | Sep 2020 – Jun 2024 | Advisor: Prof. Yanan Wang
Bachelor's Degree in International Economics and Trade | GPA: 4.84/5.00 | Academic Rank: 5/86
Selected Coursework: Econometrics; Probability and Statistics; Linear Algebra; Calculus; Microeconomics
Bachelor's Thesis: The Impact of International Students from BRICS Countries on China's Export Trade

RESEARCH INTERESTS & METHODS

Research Areas: Economics of Education; Higher Education Policy and Evaluation; Nontraditional Students and Postsecondary Pathways; Educational Inequality
Methods: Applied Econometrics (e.g., DID, IV, PSM); Panel Data Analysis; Research Synthesis and Meta-Analysis
Software: Stata; R; Mplus; Python; NVivo

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Manuscripts Under Review

Shen, Y., & Yao, H. Second chances, unequal trajectories: Adult higher education after vocational tracking in China. Under review at *British Journal of Sociology of Education*.

Peer-reviewed publications

Xu, H., **Shen, Y.**, Chen, G., & Yao, H. (in press). From access to learning gains: Motivational profiles, learning processes, and competence development among adult learners at an open university. *Open Education Research*. [In Chinese; CSSCI-indexed; CNKI Composite Impact Factor: 11.401.]

Shen, Y., Wu, Y., Na, X., & Wang, A. (2023). The impact of agricultural mechanization on the efficiency of agricultural carbon emissions in China—Based on the Super-SBM-Tobit model. *Environmental Ecology,* 5(10), 53–61. [In Chinese; 31 citations in CNKI, October 2026.]

Wu, Y., **Shen, Y.**, Xu, S., & Liang, R. (2023). Study on coupling coordination development of agricultural production efficiency and carbon emissions in Yangtze River Economic Belt. *Acta Agriculturae Jiangxi,* 35(6), 149–157. [In Chinese; 10 citations in CNKI, October 2026.]

Selected Working Papers

Shen, Y., Wu, Y., & Yao, H. *Do University Excellence Initiatives Transform Cities? Entrepreneurship, Innovation, and Urban Economic Development in China.* [In Chinese]

Shen, Y., Chen, S., Cheung, A. C. K., & Chen, Y. *Beyond performance gains: A three-level meta-analysis of the effects of generative AI on EFL learners' motivation, emotion, and self-efficacy.*

Chen, S., Cheung, A. C. K., **Shen, Y.***, & Ho, S. M. *Beyond the hype: A three-level meta-analysis on the effects of artificial intelligence on university students' self-regulated learning.* (* Corresponding author)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research on Adult Higher Education and Learner Outcomes | 2025–2026

- Designed and led a first-author study of 11,408 adult higher education graduates in China, using ordered logistic regression, matching, weighting, and sensitivity analyses to examine disparities in wage mobility associated with secondary vocational tracking and their heterogeneity across employment contexts.
- Contributed to a study of 9,880 adult learners at an open university using latent class analysis and regression to examine motivational profiles, learning processes, and competence development; independently drafted the full initial manuscript and participated in subsequent revisions, resulting in a second-author publication accepted by Open Education Research (CSSCI-indexed).

Ministry of Education Major Research Project (24JZD015) | Sep 2024–Present

Synergistic Effects of Scale, Structure, and Quality of Higher Education on High-Quality Economic and Social Development

PI: Prof. Yaozong Hu, East China Normal University

- Conceived and led a first-author difference-in-differences study using panel data from 285 Chinese cities (2007–2022) to evaluate the effects of China's Double First-Class university initiative on entrepreneurship, innovation, university–industry collaboration, and urban economic development.
- Developing my master's thesis on how changes in university program structures relate to emerging industry development, using longitudinal administrative data and text-based measures of program–industry alignment.

Shanghai Municipal Education Commission Commissioned Research Project | Jan 2026–Present

Strategic Research and Policy Design for Extending Compulsory Education in China

PI: Prof. Yaozong Hu, East China Normal University

- Independently drafted the education-finance section of a faculty-led policy study on extending compulsory education in China, examining the allocation of fiscal authority and expenditure responsibilities between central and local governments.
- Compiled and analyzed national budget accounts, education expenditure statistics, and student-aid reports from 2015–2024 to estimate intergovernmental expenditure shares and transfer payments across education levels and develop financing options for expanded free and compulsory education.

Shanghai Municipal Education Commission Commissioned Research Project | Sep–Dec 2024

Comparative Study of Education Expenditure in Shanghai and OECD Countries

PI: Prof. Yaozong Hu, East China Normal University

- Independently prepared a comparative policy analysis of doctoral education in Shanghai and OECD countries, examining doctoral attainment, STEM field composition, and program expansion, and developed recommendations on doctoral education funding and disciplinary allocation.

National Social Science Fund of China, Key Project (20AGL030) | Jun–Sep 2025

Strategic Management of National Education Systems Adapting to Demographic Change

PI: Prof. Yaozong Hu, East China Normal University

- Co-authored the chapter on China's vocational bachelor's pilot, analyzing policy formulation, diffusion, implementation, and institutional transition pathways through policy-process frameworks and comparative case evidence.
- Led the student writing team for the approximately 130,000-word vocational education section of the project book manuscript, coordinating chapter structure, task allocation, and manuscript development with the PI.

Shanghai Municipal Government Policy Advisory Project | Nov 2025–Feb 2026

Reform Paths for Optimizing and Upgrading Shanghai Higher Education Clusters

PI: Prof. Hao Yao, East China Normal University

- Independently authored a comparative case-study chapter on Greater Boston, using regional innovation systems and Triple Helix frameworks to examine how universities function as anchor institutions across government-led, university-led, and industry-led innovation spaces.

Jiading District Key Education Research Project | Nov 2024–Present

Constructing Curriculum Leadership Systems in K–12 Schools from a Cross-Boundary Perspective

PI: Prof. Hui Dong, East China Normal University

- Served as the sole student researcher in the proposal-development stage; co-developed the research topic with the PI and drafted the full initial proposal, including the literature review, conceptual framework, mixed-methods research design, implementation plan, and expected outcomes.
- Developing a conceptual paper with the PI that draws on Honig's perspective on educational complexity to reconceptualize curriculum leadership and propose a three-dimensional framework for "Curriculum Leadership 2.0."

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Shen, Y., & Yao, H. (2027). Second chances, unequal trajectories: Adult higher education after vocational tracking in China. Accepted for presentation at the *71st Annual Meeting of the Comparative and International Education Society (**CIES**),* Madison, WI, USA.

Chen, S., Cheung, A. C. K., **Shen, Y.**, & Ho, S. M. (2026). Beyond the hype: A three-level meta-analysis on the effects of artificial intelligence on university students' self-regulated learning. Paper presented at the *Annual Conference of the British Educational Research Association (**BERA**),* Manchester, UK.

Shen, Y., Chen, S., Cheung, A. C. K., & Chen, Y. (2026). How does GenAI impact EFL learners' motivation, emotion and self-efficacy: A meta-analysis of experimental studies. Paper presented at the *Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association (**AERA**),* Los Angeles, CA, USA.

Shen, Y., & Yao, H. (2026). Can Adult Higher Education Erase the Past? The Persistent Penalty of Vocational Tracks in China. Paper presented at the *EdUHK International Postgraduate Conference and Research Forum (**IPCRF**),* Hong Kong. **Outstanding Paper Award**.

Shen, Y., & Yao, H. (2026). Can Adult Higher Education Erase the Past? The Persistent Penalty of Vocational Tracks in China. Paper presented at the *Jiangsu Annual Conference on Education Economics,* Zhenjiang, China. **First Prize Paper Award**.

Shen, Y., Wu, Y., & Yao, H. (2025). Do University Excellence Initiatives Transform Cities? Entrepreneurship, Innovation, and Urban Economic Development in China. Paper presented at the *Jiangsu Annual Conference on Education Economics,* Nanjing, China. **First Prize Paper Award**.

Shen, Y., Chen, S., Cheung, A. C. K., & Chen, Y. (2025). How does GenAI impact EFL learners' motivation, emotion and self-efficacy: A meta-analysis of experimental studies. Paper presented at the *CUHK China Education Forum*, Hong Kong.

Shen, Y., Wu, Y., & Yao, H. (2025). Do University Excellence Initiatives Transform Cities? Entrepreneurship, Innovation, and Urban Economic Development in China. Paper presented at the *Peking University Forum on Education Economics and Management,* Beijing, China.

Shen, Y., Wu, Y., & Yao, H. (2025). Do University Excellence Initiatives Transform Cities? Entrepreneurship, Innovation, and Urban Economic Development in China. Poster presented at the *14th Doctoral Forum, School of Education, Tsinghua University,* Beijing, China.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Tuition and Free College Policy | Sep 2025–Jan 2026

East China Normal University

Instructor: Prof. Yaozong Hu

- Contributed to syllabus and course design for an undergraduate elective in economics of education covering tuition, educational costs, teacher compensation, cost sharing, student financial aid, fiscal transfers, and educational equity.
- Developed instructional materials by synthesizing textbooks, current research, and government policy documents, and assisted with assignment assessment and grading.

Honors & Awards

Scholarship for Academic Excellence, East China Normal University, 2025, 2026

Outstanding Graduate, Hohai University, 2024

Scholarship for Academic Excellence & Social Work, Hohai University, 2021, 2022, 2023

Outstanding Student Leader, Hohai University, 2022, 2023

Outstanding Student, Hohai University, 2021, 2022, 2023

Social Practice Excellence Award, Hohai University, 2022

Grand Prize, POCIB National Foreign Trade Skills Competition (Team Leader), 2023

Third Prize, Management Decision Simulation Competition (Team Leader), 2022

Educational Outreach & Community Engagement

Shengyao Primary School, Bozhou, Anhui, China

Project Leader & Volunteer Teacher | Jul–Aug 2022

- Led a 16-member volunteer teaching team serving approximately 300 rural primary school students; coordinated enrichment courses and taught Chinese calligraphy.

Hanqiao Central Primary School, Huai'an, Jiangsu, China

Volunteer Teacher & Course Instructor | Jul–Aug 2021

- Taught Chinese calligraphy in a summer volunteer education program, introducing primary school students to traditional Chinese calligraphy and basic brush-writing techniques.

Additional Information

Languages: English (IELTS Academic: 7.5, Mar 2026), Mandarin (native)

Leadership & Service: Student Union President, Hohai University (Aug 2022–Sep 2023); Class President, Hohai University (Sep 2021–Sep 2022)